The Feeling Stream and X

A simple model of how we experience, think and use language

> *PSM says that what we experience is a continuous stream of feeling. Everything that comes into the brain — sound, sight, memory, thought — changes this stream. The stream is our ongoing subjective experience.*

1. A continuous stream of feeling

Your brain is always receiving information. It never stops. This includes:

- sound & vision
- bodily signals
- expectations
- thoughts
- smell & touch
- memories
- language
- inner simulations

Different parts of the brain handle these different inputs. According to PSM, all of them continuously affect one shared stream — the feeling stream. That stream is simply the ongoing process of what it feels like to be you right now.

2. What is a feeling?

A feeling is rarely just one single emotion. Many things can be active at the same time:

fear | joy | curiosity | expectation | memory

body state | social meaning | desire | uncertainty

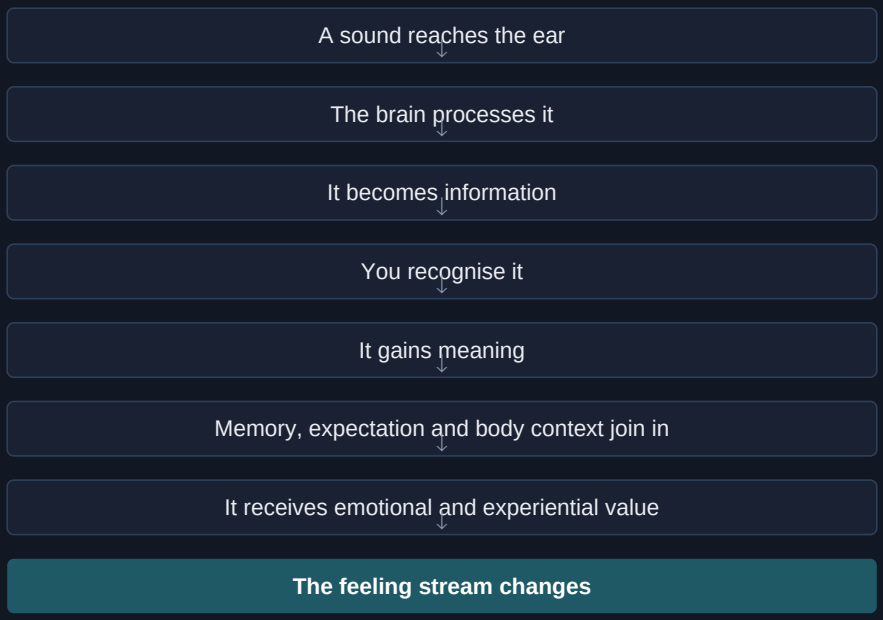
↓ **all of these combine** ↓

into the feeling stream you experience right now

The feeling you notice is the overall state created by all these processes together. It is not always the strongest single emotion that wins — it is the combined result.

3. How input changes the stream

Everything that enters the brain can change how you feel. Take sound as an example:



The sound itself is not the feeling. The sound is processed into information. That information gets meaning and value. And that value is what changes the feeling stream.

The same path applies to images, smells, touch, words, memories and thoughts.

> *Input is not the feeling. Input becomes information with meaning and value — and that value changes the continuous feeling stream.*

4. X is the “now” point

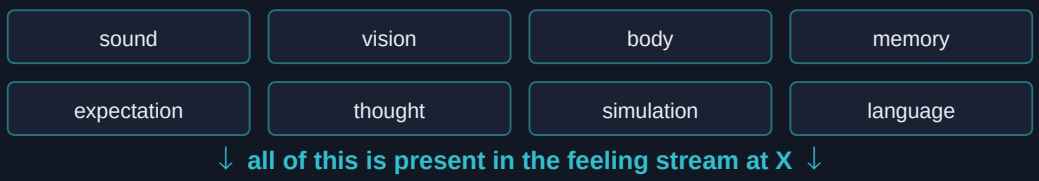
X is not a place in the brain. It is not a processor or an integration machine. X is simply:

> *the present point in time within the continuous feeling stream.*

The stream is the process of experience. X is the moment that is currently being lived. The stream keeps moving through successive moments, while X marks the one that is present right now.

5. What is present at X

At any moment, many processes can be active at the same time:



X does not actively combine these processes. The state of the stream at X simply is the current subjective experience.

> *X does not create the stream. The stream passes through X.*

6. What is a thought?

PSM does not treat thought as language alone. A thought can be organised through any of these:

- words
- images
- spatial relationships
- memories
- predictions
- simulations
- any combination of the above

> *A thought is an organised process within the feeling stream that represents, connects, evaluates or simulates information.*

7. Language and thought

Language is one of the systems the brain uses to organise thought. Words work like hooks. They connect the present moment to larger networks of:

- meaning
- memories
- images
- experiences
- expectations
- emotional value

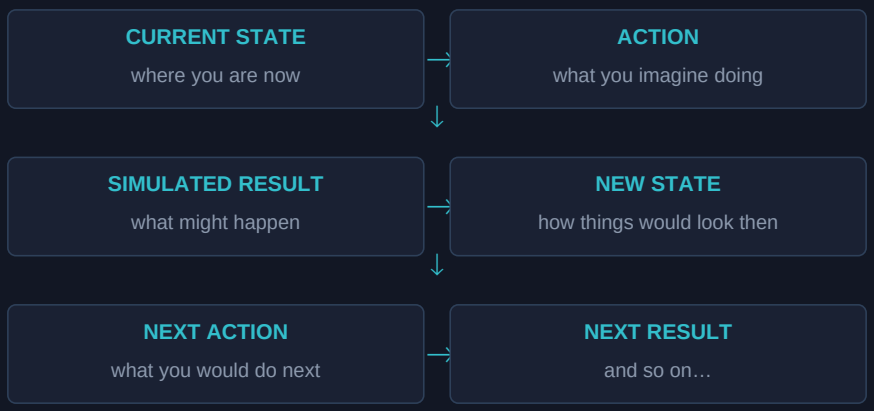
> *Language is a system the brain uses to encode, organise and retrieve emotional and experiential value within the feeling stream.*

> *In short: words are feelings and experiences organised into a symbolic system.*

8. Thinking without words

Thinking does not have to be verbal. You can run an internal simulation of an event — a sequence of images, movements, spatial relationships, consequences and emotional responses. That is still thinking.

A simple simulation loop looks like this:



The simulation itself can change the feeling stream. And the changed feeling stream can influence the next step of the simulation. This creates a continuous internal loop that does not need any external input.

9. The continuous feedback loop

The whole process never really stops. It forms a continuous loop. X is only the current “now” point inside that ongoing stream.

10. The complete picture

Putting it all together:

The world

Input reaches the senses

The brain processes it

Information gains meaning

Memory, expectation and body join in

Emotional and experiential value is added

The feeling stream changes

Words, images or simulations appear

A thought is formed

New meaning and value are created

The feeling stream changes again

X marks the present moment

The stream continues

Core definitions — in plain language

Feeling stream

The continuous process of subjective experience — what it feels like to be you, moment by moment.

Feeling

The combined state produced by many simultaneous processes (emotions, body, memory, expectation, etc.) inside that stream.

Thought

An organised process within the stream that represents, connects, evaluates or simulates information. It can use words, images, or both.

Language

One system the brain uses to organise and sequence thought. Words act as hooks that connect the present moment to meaning, memory and emotional value.

X

The “now” point in the continuous feeling stream. X does not create the stream — the stream simply passes through X.

The central relationship: Feeling stream → thought → new information/value → feeling stream → X → present experience → continuing stream.

Draft · Working hypothesis · Not peer-reviewed